

EXPLORE | DIGITAL SKILLS

Navigating your AWS account

Introduction

In this train we will be exploring how to sign up for an AWS account. You will access the AWS Management Console and start **Navigating your AWS account** to interact with remote computing resources.

Here the main objective is to ensure that you have a good understanding of how to access AWS and use the AWS Management Console to navigate to the services you can use on your AWS free tier account. You will also learn about the cost risk associated and how to avoid incurring any charges on your free tier account.



Creating a Free Tier Account

Welcome to **Navigating your AWS account**, in this train you will learn how to access and navigate around AWS. To get started go to: <https://aws.amazon.com/console/>

1. On the AWS Management Console login page you will see a Console Overview section with links to information about free tier accounts, global infrastructure and more. Now click on 'Create a Free Account'.
2. The next screen you're going to see is the 'Create an AWS' account page where you will need to provide your basic information, including your email address. Once you have provided your details click on continue.

The screenshot shows the AWS Management Console login page. It is divided into two main sections, labeled 1 and 2. Section 1, 'Console Overview', lists several features: 'Discover and experiment with over 150 AWS services, many of which have free trials', 'Build your cloud-based applications in any AWS data center throughout the world', 'Manage and monitor users, service usage, health, and monthly billing', and 'Get in-console help from AWS Support'. Below this list is an orange button labeled 'Create a Free Account'. Section 2, 'Create an AWS account', contains a form with the following fields: 'Email address', 'Password', 'Confirm password', and 'AWS account name'. Below the form is a yellow button labeled 'Continue'. At the bottom of the form, there is a link 'Sign in to an existing AWS account' and a footer with copyright information: '© 2021 Amazon Web Services, Inc. or its affiliates. All rights reserved. Privacy Policy Terms of Use'.

1 Console Overview

- Discover and experiment with over 150 AWS services, many of which have free trials
- Build your cloud-based applications in any AWS data center throughout the world
- Manage and monitor users, service usage, health, and monthly billing
- Get in-console help from AWS Support

Create a Free Account

2 Create an AWS account

Email address

Password

Confirm password

AWS account name ⓘ

Continue

[Sign in to an existing AWS account](#)

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AWS Free Tier Sign-Up

On the Contact Information page you will select the personal account type and fill in your FULL NAME, PHONE NUMBER, COUNTRY/REGION and ADDRESS. Then agree to the AWS customer agreement to continue.

Contact Information

All fields are required.

Please select the account type and complete the fields below with your contact details.

Account type ⓘ
☒ Professional ☐ Personal

Full name

Company name

Phone number

Country/Region

Address

With your basic information now captured you can now add your credit or debit card info on the Payment Information page. For card verification purposes, you are charged a very small nominal amount. This amount is often around R1.

Payment Information

All fields are required.

We use your payment information to verify your identity and only for usage in excess of the [AWS Free Tier Limits](#). We will not charge you for usage below the AWS Free Tier Limits. To learn more about payment options, review our [Frequently Asked Questions](#).

ⓘ When you submit your payment information, we will charge ZAR 1 to your credit card as a verification charge to ensure your card is valid. The amount may show as pending in your credit card statement for 3-5 days until the verification is completed, at which time the charge will be removed. You may be redirected to your bank website to authorize the verification charge.

Credit card number


AWS accepts most major credit cards.

Expiration date

Cardholder's name

Creating a free tier account

1. The final step to getting your free tier access is to confirm your identity by providing your cell phone number and the security check characters displayed on screen. Make sure you have selected the correct region.
2. With that done you will get an SMS with a corresponding 4-digit verification code. To complete your sign up simply type in the code.

1 Confirm your identity

Before you can use your AWS account, you must verify your phone number. When you continue, the AWS automated system will contact you with a verification code.

How should we send you the verification code?
☒ Text message (SMS) ☐ Voice call

Country or region code
South Africa (+27)

Cell Phone Number

Security check

yg 4 nvg

Type the characters as shown above

2 Enter verification code

Enter the 4-digit verification code that you received on your phone.

Verify Code

Having trouble? Sometimes it takes up to 10 minutes to receive a verification code. If it's been longer than that, [return to the previous page](#) and enter your number again.

Creating a free tier account

1. Congratulation! You are now registered on AWS as a free tier account user. With everything now set up you can sign in to the AWS Management Console. Click on the Go to AWS Management Console button to be redirected to the sign in page.
2. On the sign in page login as a 'Root user' to access the account you have just created. As you go through the course you will learn more about IAM user access.

The screenshot shows the AWS sign-in process with two numbered steps:

1 Congratulations! Thank you for signing up with AWS. We are activating your account, which should take a few minutes. You will receive an email when this is complete. [Go to the AWS Management Console](#) [Sign up for another account or Contact Sales](#)

2 Sign in

☒ **Root user**
Account owner that performs tasks requiring unrestricted access. [Learn more](#)

☐ **IAM user**
User within an account that performs daily tasks. [Learn more](#)

Root user email address

[Next](#)

☐ New to AWS?

[Create a new AWS account](#)

Understanding Free Tier Services in AWS

There are 3 types of offers available for free tier users in AWS. The first is for services that are **Always Free**; these free tier services do not expire. The **12 Months Free** offer will give you access to AWS services for 12 months, starting from the day you sign-up. Finally there are short-term free offers called **Free Trials**. These services are available for only a short period of time, and you pay standard rates after the trial period expires.

ALWAYS FREE

DATABASE

Free Tier ALWAYS FREE

Amazon DynamoDB

25 GB

of storage

Fast and flexible NoSQL database with seamless scalability.

25 GB of Storage

▼

12 MONTHS FREE

COMPUTE

Free Tier 12 MONTHS FREE

Amazon EC2

750 Hours

per month

Resizable compute capacity in the Cloud.

750 hours per month of Linux, RHEL, or SLES

▼

FREE TRIAL

MACHINE LEARNING NEW

Free Tier FREE TRIAL

Amazon SageMaker

2 Months

free trial

Machine learning for every data scientist and developer.

250 hours per month of ml.t3.medium on

▼

Billing Warning

Here are a few things to keep in mind when you sign up for the AWS Free Tier:

- Not all AWS services have a free tier offering.
- There are limits to the free tier offering for each service.
- Any resources or usage thresholds that aren't covered by the free tier are billed at standard rates.

When using AWS Free Tier, you might incur charges due to the following reasons:

- You exceeded the monthly free tier usage limits of one or more services.
- You're using an AWS service, such as [Amazon Aurora](#), that doesn't offer free tier benefits.
- Your free tier period expired.

Billing Warning

While using AWS services it is possible to incur additional charges. Here are a few helpful tips to help avoid this:

- Sign in with a free tier AWS account, not all AWS services have a free tier offering.
- Identify the resources that are billed for on your account.
- Delete, shut down, or terminate any resources that are not running and you don't want to be billed for.
- Monitor your usage of AWS Free Tier resources regularly using the [Billing and Cost Management console](#).
- Use [AWS Budgets](#) to monitor your Free Tier usage.



Important: The practical part of this module is optional. We will not cover cover any charges accidentally incurred.

AWS Management Console

Now you can start to explore the AWS services available for your account. At the top of the screen there is a search bar for easy access. On the AWS Management Console landing page there is a list of all the AWS services in their respective categories and your own list of recently used services will be populated.

The screenshot shows the AWS Management Console interface. At the top, there is a navigation bar with the AWS logo, a 'Services' dropdown menu, a search bar, and a region dropdown menu set to 'Ohio'. The main content area is titled 'AWS Management Console' and features a grid of service categories. A red box highlights the 'Recently visited services' section, which includes S3, Lambda, Amazon SageMaker, DynamoDB, EC2, Trusted Advisor, AWS Cost Explorer, Billing, Amazon Rekognition, and EC2 Image Builder. Another red box highlights the search bar. A third red box highlights the 'Services' dropdown menu. A fourth red box highlights the 'All services' section, which lists various service categories like Compute, Quantum Technologies, Management & Governance, and Security, Identity, & Compliance. A fifth red box highlights the 'Ohio' region dropdown menu. Callouts provide additional context: 'Choose the service that you want from the Services drop down list with all available AWS services' points to the 'Services' dropdown; 'Search bar for AWS services' points to the search bar; 'You can choose an AWS Region for many of the services to specify where your resources are managed and run. Some services such as IAM do not require you to specify a region' points to the 'Ohio' dropdown; 'Recently visited services' points to the 'Recently visited services' section.

Choose the service that you want from the Services drop down list with all available AWS services

Search bar for AWS services

You can choose an AWS Region for many of the services to specify where your resources are managed and run. Some services such as IAM do not require you to specify a region

Recently visited services

AWS Management Console

Selecting a service automatically directs you to its respective configuration dashboard. Here you are provided with a multitude of options and tools to enable you to launch and interact with remote computing resources related to the specific service.

The screenshot shows the AWS Management Console for the EC2 service in the US East (Ohio) Region. The left navigation pane is open, showing options like 'New EC2 Experience', 'EC2 Dashboard', 'Events', 'Tags', 'Limits', 'Instances', 'Instance Types', 'Launch Templates', 'Spot Requests', and 'Savings Plans'. The main content area is divided into several sections: 'Resources' showing counts for various EC2 resources, 'Launch instance' with a prominent orange button, 'Scheduled events', 'Service health' showing the service is operating normally, and 'Zone status' showing all three availability zones are operating normally. On the right, there are sidebars for 'Account attributes' and 'Explore AWS'.

Resource	Count
Instances (running)	0
Instances (all states)	0
Placement groups	0
Volumes	0
Dedicated Hosts	0
Key pairs	0
Security groups	1
Elastic IPs	0
Load balancers	0
Snapshots	0

Zone	Status
us-east-2a (use2-az1)	Zone is operating normally
us-east-2b (use2-az2)	Zone is operating normally
us-east-2c (use2-az3)	Zone is operating normally

On each AWS service screen you will have a navigation pane will be available to the left, enabling easy access to any options available for that specific service.

Conclusion

An **AWS Free Tier** account enables you to gain free, hands-on experience with products on the AWS platform. AWS Free Tier includes 3 free offer types (Always Free, 12 Months Free and Trial), for a full list of AWS Free Tier services, please refer to the [AWS Free Tier](#) website.

The **AWS Management Console** is a web application that provides a broad collection of service dashboards for managing Amazon Web Services. The service console has an intuitive user interface for exploring how to launch, run, terminate, connect, secure services and resources. The Management Console also offers a wide range of tools for cloud computing, as well as information about your account.

If you are an account owner or you have the necessary permissions, you can get information about your billing information. Use the **AWS Billing and Cost Management** dashboard to find a summary and a breakdown of your monthly spending. This can help you avoid incurring unnecessary cost.

Appendix

Useful links to billing FAQs:

- [How do I make sure I don't incur charges when I'm using the AWS Free Tier?](#)
- [I unintentionally incurred charges while using the AWS Free Tier. How do I make sure that I'm not billed again?](#)

[The AWS Cloud Adoption Framework \(AWS CAF\)](#)

leverages AWS experience and best practices to help you digitally transform and accelerate your business outcomes through the innovative use of AWS.

